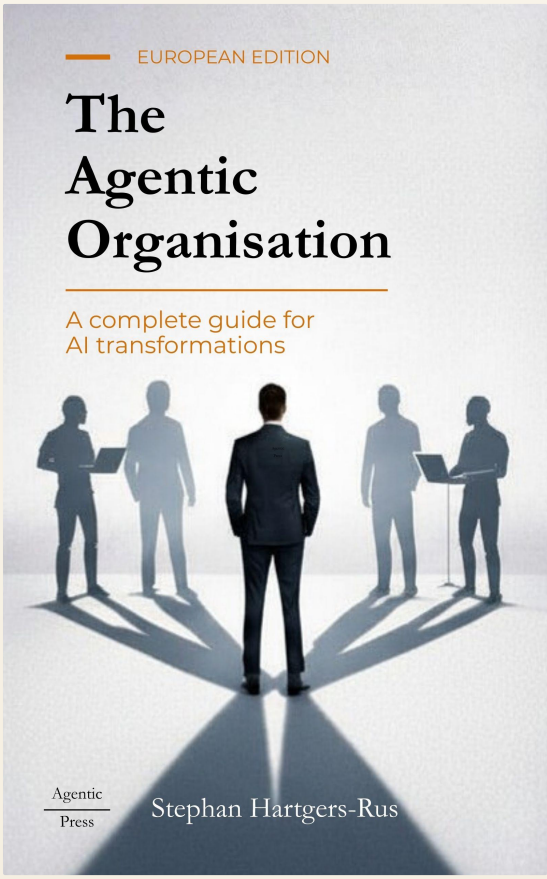


The Agentic Organisation

A complete guide for AI transformations

EUROPEAN EDITION

Stephan Hartgers-Rus

> *"The question most boardrooms are asking is the wrong one."*

PRE-ORDER NOW PUBLISHING 1 MAY 2026 ALL MAJOR BOOKSTORES

WHY THIS BOOK

The right question is harder

"How do we adopt AI?" sounds strategic. It leads to pilots, proofs of concept, and a lot of activity. It also leads, in the vast majority of organisations, to no sustained impact.

The harder question belongs in the room where strategy, governance, and culture are decided: *how do we lead an organisation that can absorb and act on AI?* This is the largest paradigm shift since the industrial revolution. Treating it as another software rollout is the single most expensive mistake a leadership team can make.

European CEOs are not underprepared because they lack ambition or intelligence. They are underprepared because the mental model most of them are applying, incremental and project-based, is structurally incapable of capturing what this moment demands.

This book gives the mental model and the sequence. It is written from and for Europe deliberately: the EU AI Act, GDPR-era data discipline, and European labour dialogue are a different playing field with distinct advantages, not constraints to work around.

95%
of enterprise generative AI implementations fail to deliver sustained, measurable impact.
MIT NANDA, 2025

3.6×
three-year total shareholder return at the top 5% of AI leaders vs. their peers.

4 months
the doubling time of AI task-completion capability since 2024.

2026
ING signals an "agentic enterprise" shift to investors at the Morgan Stanley European Financials Conference in London.

THE CORE IDEA

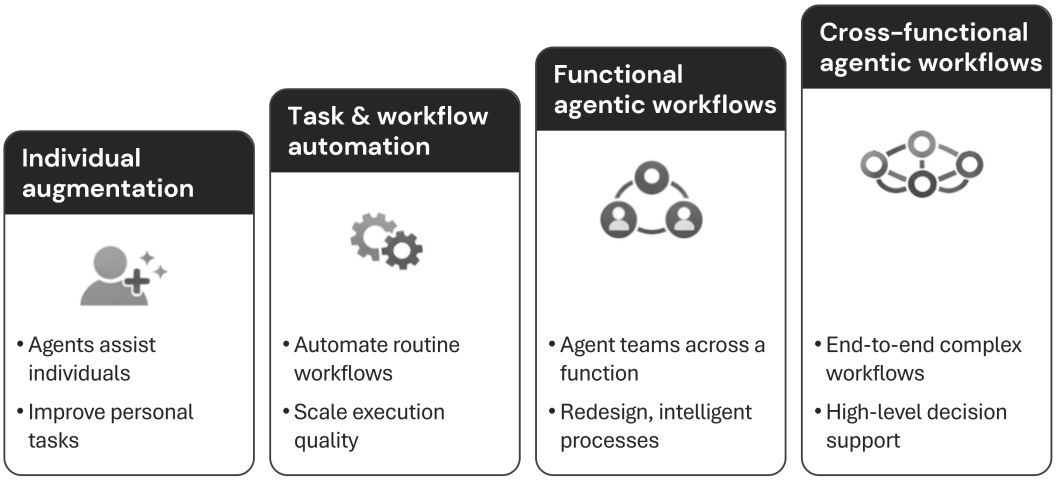
What is the Agentic Organisation?

> **DEFINITION · THE AGENTIC ORGANISATION**
>
> The Agentic Organisation is a company redesigned so that humans and AI agents work together as a unified system.

Getting there is not a technology project. It is a leadership project with a clear sequence: understand the shift, own the leadership requirement, learn what the destination looks like, then build it in stages with the right foundations and the right measures.

The work compounds (or fails to) across four tiers. An agentic *employee* is more productive than a non-agentic one. An agentic *team* produces outcomes neither humans nor AI alone could. An agentic *department* rewires its operating model. An agentic *organisation* redesigns strategy, structure, and governance around that model. Each tier requires different things from leadership; skip one and the next will not hold.

Agentic systems scale with task complexity



Transformation compounds across four tiers. Leaders who only act at the individual or team level capture a fraction of the value.

A CLOSER LOOK

Most AI programmes are not transformations.

They are productivity theatre. Real transformation demands that capability compound: from individual to team, from team to department, from department to the whole organisation. The graveyard is specific: for every **33 proofs of concept** that enter production pipelines, only **four** emerge.

The leap that kills the most initiatives is the one from team to department: from Tier 2 to Tier 3, where a function is meant to start running on agentic workflows. Most departments do the opposite: they add AI on top of existing processes, existing org charts, existing decision-making structures, and ask it to make things faster. That produces a faster version of the same thing. It does not produce transformation.

Done properly, a departmental redesign looks different. Consider a finance function at Tier 3. Agent 1 extracts invoice data. Agent 2 pulls the relevant contract. Agent 3 flags discrepancies. Agent 4 drafts the resolution email. A human intervenes only at the decision point. A team of two to five people supervises an "agent factory" of 50 to 100 specialised agents running an entire process. Cycle times fall by up to **80%**. Audit trails improve.

That is not a thought experiment. At Airbus, **10,000 engineers** trained on AI coding tools achieved a **40%** improvement in simulation cycle times. Across European organisations more broadly, 56% increased profits or reduced costs through AI, with an average financial impact of over six million euros per firm.

> *And yet even the best departmental redesign stalls short of the prize.*

Tier 4, cross-functional agentic workflows, where AI becomes the connective tissue between departments rather than a tool within them, is where real compounding happens. A demand surge in one region triggers, within seconds, reallocated advertising spend, adjusted pricing, rerouted stock, and refreshed creative across the whole organisation.

What unlocks that is not a better model. Not a bigger budget. Not a smarter data team. It is something most boards have never governed for — and it is why the rest of this book exists.

INSIDE THE BOOK

Sixteen chapters. One leadership playbook.

PART I · BUILDING MOMENTUM

1 The Largest Shift Since the Industrial Revolution
2 When Sponsorship Is Not Enough

PART II · THE MODEL

3 What the Agentic Organisation Looks Like
4 When Local Wins Don't Add Up
5 Every Transformation Needs a Map
6 The Vision Layer
7 The Product Layer
8 The Operational Layer
9 The Foundational Layer
10 The AI Decision Lens

PART III · THE EUROPEAN ADVANTAGE

11 Europe's Distinctive Edge
12 The Decisions That Mattered

PART IV · THE CEO'S PLAYBOOK

13 Building Your Agentic Organisation
14 Readiness
15 Measuring What Matters
16 A Leadership Decision

Nine decisions. Six European companies. One playbook.

BBVA · ING · Siemens
Allianz · Klarna · Schneider Electric

Chapter 12 distils nine transferable lessons from leaders who decided under pressure.

GET THE BOOK

Three years from now, two kinds of organisations will exist.

One will have built the Agentic Organisation. The other will still be piloting. This book is for leaders who have already decided which one they want to be.

The Agentic Organisation

A complete guide for AI transformations — European edition

by Stephan Hartgers-Rus

HARDBACK	978-90-836902-0-9
PAPERBACK	978-90-836902-1-6
EPUB	978-90-836902-2-3

Stephan Hartgers-Rus *is CEO of Xomnia and a former McKinsey strategy consultant with 25+ years helping organisations turn technology into value. He holds degrees in Econometrics and Computer Science and lives in The Hague.*

Scan to buy on Amazon

amazon.nl/dp/9083690202

WORK WITH XOMNIA

xomnia

We make AI work.

The Amsterdam-based data and AI consultancy the author leads. We partner with organisations across Europe to turn AI strategy into measurable, agentic impact.

DATA & AI STRATEGY · CLOUD DATA PLATFORMS · AGENTIC PRODUCTS

xomnia.com

PRE-ORDER NOW PUBLISHING 1 MAY 2026 ALL MAJOR BOOKSTORES